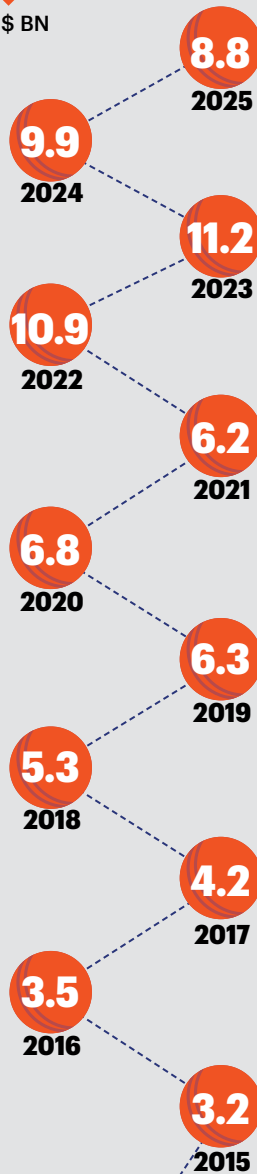


VALUATION OF IPL OVER THE YEARS

IN \$ BN



SOURCE D&P ADVISORY REPORT

sponsorship spend.

Sponsorships matured over time, too. The sponsors once bought a logo space on a jersey and called it a campaign. They now demand 360-degree integration, digital activation, co-branded content, and grassroots programmes. The shift reflects the rise of the fan economy, where brands expect measurable returns, not just visibility. For instance, Swiggy, the food-delivery app, has tied up with Jio Hotstar to integrate its food ordering while watching the match live.

At the franchise level, each IPL team now manages approximately 25 brand partnerships annually, spanning fintech, FMCG, edtech, and more. Ticketing, merchandising, and licensing remain secondary but growing streams.

THE GLOBAL PLAY

The headline story of IPL's growth may be the surge in broadcast and title sponsorship revenues. Yet, the game changer for franchises has been more strategic: going global and turning themselves into multi-league operators.

In 2015, Knight Riders—the parent company of KKR—bought a majority stake in the Trinidad and Tobago team of the newly launched Caribbean Premier League (CPL). It was a quiet move, barely noticed outside cricket's business circles. The following season, they renamed the team Trinbago Knight Riders, extending the Knight Riders brand overseas. The team won the CPL title that very first year.

For several years, this remained a lone experiment. The CPL had launched in 2013, the Big Bash in Australia relaunched its city-franchise format around the

same time, all liberally replicating the IPL's playbook of city identity, player auctions, and broadcast-first packaging. Yet, IPL ownership money largely stayed home.

The inflexion point came in 2021-22. RR's parent acquired a major stake in the Barbados team of the CPL, the second such move by an IPL team owner. Then, in 2022, two new leagues were launched, SA20 in South Africa and ILT20 in the UAE. Now, all six teams in SA20 are owned by IPL franchise owners. While in ILT20, Reliance Industries, GMR Group and Knight Riders own a team each. Additionally, Adani Sportslines, not an IPL franchise owner but owner of Gujarat Giants in Women's Premier League (WPL), also owns a team in ILT20.

Major League Cricket (MLC) in the United States was launched in 2023 on the same template. Four out of the six teams in the MLC are owned by IPL franchise owners. The most recent chapter is England. For years, The Hundred remained closed to private investors, but in 2025, that changed, and IPL money moved in quickly.

RPSG Group, owners of LSG, bought a 70% stake in Manchester Originals for around £81 million. Reliance Industries acquired a 49% stake in Oval Invincibles for £60 million, and Sun Group, owners of Sunrisers Hyderabad, acquired 100% of Northern Superchargers for £100 million.

The Big Bash in Australia remains closed for investments but is in the process of potential privatisation. Cricket Australia is pushing to sell up to 49% stakes in most teams and 100% of two teams to secure private funding.

But IPL is different not just for